Training and validation curves

Learn to understand, design, build, test and explain AI systems responsibly.

Project: Image-pattern Network Investigation

TEACHER GUIDE · 1 OF 9

Prepare the purpose, prerequisites and materials

> Prepare Training and validation curves: check the target, prerequisites, resources and adaptable teaching schedule.

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Compute comparable **training** and validation losses at saved **checkpoint**s

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

> **Session:** Session 1 · Understand · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.
>
> **Resources:** Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

> **Session:** Session 2 · Practise · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.
>
> **Resources:** Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

> **Session:** Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.
>
> **Resources:** Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building.

Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new **evidence**.

Retrieval answer guidance

Learning rate experiments

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Learning rate experiments. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Run a controlled comparison of learning rates

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: First v = 0.5 with MSE 5.625. Second gradient -7.5 gives v = 0.875 and MSE 3.1640625. Distance is multiplied by 0.75 each step.

Training a small network

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from **Training** a small network. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Trace repeated forward loss gradient and update steps

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: **Prediction**s [0, 0], errors [-2, -4], MSE 10, gradient -10 and new v = 1.

Slopes and local change

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Slopes and local change. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Calculate an average rate of change over a stated interval

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Average slope is (0 - 4) / 2 = -2. The local slope at 2 is zero. They describe different locations or intervals.

Use two 45-minute sessions. Have students draw **checkpoint** number horizontally and MSE vertically, using one clearly labelled scale for both curves.

Explicitly name the differing target rules in this synthetic example so the picture is not misrepresented as proof of a single over**fitting mechanism**. Keep **checkpoint** selection separate from parameter updates.

Outcomes

Compute comparable **training** and validation losses at saved **checkpoint**s

Choose among observed **checkpoint**s using a declared validation rule

Distinguish development **evidence** from final test **evidence**

Preparation

Printed lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 editor; no packages or AI accounts needed

Use the fictional examples supplied; prepare the fresh retry before class

Prerequisite answer

Training loss measures fit to the examples used for updates. Independent performance needs suitable separate **evidence**, and settings selected using validation must not be presented as independent final testing.

End goal for the pictorial case

By the end, I can explain **training** and **validation curve**s using a traced example and a stated limitation.

This added worked case illustrates the week’s main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

Explain and model the mechanism

> Model Training and validation curves using the supplied case, labelled mechanism and reasoning. Make the scope of each conclusion explicit.

Explain Training and validation curves · 1

Keep the restricted network h = ReLU(x), y = vh, with only v trained. **Training** pairs remain (1, 2) and (2, 4). Start v = 0 and make four full-data updates at rate 0.1. Save states v = 0, 1, 1.5, 1.75 and 1.875.

At each saved state, evaluate both splits without changing v during evaluation.

Explain Training and validation curves · 2

For this deliberately constructed demonstration, validation pairs are (3, 4.5) and (4, 6). Their targets follow a different slope from the **training** pairs.

This makes the two trends disagree visibly; it is not **evidence** that these few rows represent a real population. Validation labels do not enter the gradient.

Both columns use ordinary MSE in the same target units, evaluated on their own fixed rows. **Training** MSE is 2.5(v - 2) squared; validation MSE is 12.5(v - 1.5) squared.

Different **input** values and target rules affect the loss levels. A gap alone does not identify its cause.

For **checkpoint** 3, v = 1.75. **Training prediction**s are [1.75, 3.5], residuals [-0.25, -0.5], and MSE 0.15625. Validation **prediction**s are [5.25, 7], residuals [0.75, 1], and MSE 0.78125.

All four **prediction**s must use the same saved value.

The code evaluates supplied **checkpoint**s; it does not train on validation data. It assumes finite numeric pairs and selects the lowest observed validation MSE, breaking exact ties in favour of the earlier **checkpoint**.

The rule is chosen before inspecting the values.

Term	Meaning
Checkpoint	Saved model parameters and the information needed to identify a training state
Training curve	A record of a training measure at successive saved states
Validation curve	A record of a development measure on separate examples at those states
Selection rule	A declared procedure for choosing among candidate models or checkpoints

Later updates improve only one split

Series	2	3	4
Training solid line	0.625	0.15625	0.0390625
Validation dashed line	0	0.78125	1.7578125

This chart shows checkpoints 2 to 4 only, on one MSE scale from 0 to 2. Circles and a solid line mark training; squares and a dashed line mark validation. Lines connect measured checkpoints, not additional evaluations. The full table includes checkpoints 0 and 1.

Explain Training and validation curves · 3

Guided: **training** changes by 0.0390625 - 0.625 = -0.5859375; validation changes by 1.7578125 - 0 = 1.7578125. Select **checkpoint** 2 with v = 1.5.

Exit: zero on selected validation examples is limited development **evidence**, and choosing with test results turns that test into development data.

Freeze choices using **training**/validation, then evaluate once on suitable untouched test examples and report the scope.

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a **prediction**, then explain the deciding step.

These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

Later updates improve only one split

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This chart shows checkpoints 2 to 4 only, on one MSE scale from 0 to 2. Circles and a solid line mark training; squares and a dashed line mark validation. Lines connect measured checkpoints, not additional evaluations. The full table includes checkpoints 0 and 1.

Using the table, calculate the training and validation loss changes from checkpoint 2 to checkpoint 4. Which saved parameter does the selection rule choose?

Thinking move	Teacher prompt
Plan	What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?
Do	Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.
Check	Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: Training and validation curves

Plot **training** and validation loss for **checkpoint**s before opening final cases.

The facts we will use

Supplied facts

Supplied **checkpoint** losses: epoch 1 train4, val3; epoch 2 train2, val2; epoch 3 train1, val2.5. Selection: smallest validation loss.

Supplied facts

All **input**s and outcomes in this worked example are invented classroom data; no real model run is claimed.

AI ACADEMY / AI-5/15

Checkpoint losses

	training	validation
epoch 1	4	3
epoch 2	2	2
epoch 3	1	2.5

Read a cell using both its row and column labels.

Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

AI ACADEMY / AI-5/15

Training and validation curves

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Read training curve

Training loss falls4 -> 2 -> 1.



2. Read validation curve

Validation loss falls3 -> 2 then rises to2.5.



3. Choose checkpoint

Select epoch 2, not epoch 3, under the declared validation criterion.

CHANGE ONE THING

Epoch3 validation loss is instead1.5.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Read the picture one step at a time

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS AND WHY
1. Read training curve	Training loss falls4→2→1.
2. Read validation curve	Validation loss falls3→2 then rises to2.5.
3. Choose checkpoint	Select epoch 2, not epoch 3, under the declared validation criterion.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Why the result follows

The **training curve** measures fit to examples used for learning. The **validation curve** measures a separate set used to choose a **checkpoint**. The final **training** loss is smallest here, but its validation loss has risen.

Under the supplied **selection rule**, keep **checkpoint** two. A later final test must remain outside both learning and **checkpoint** selection.

What this example does not establish

Keep the stated limit

A single curve has sampling and run variability; validation-selected **checkpoint**s still require untouched final **evidence**.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change one thing

Change: Epoch3 validation loss is instead1.5.

Predicted result

Prediction: Select epoch 3 under the unchanged criterion.

Why the result follows

Reason: Its measured validation loss is now below epoch 2′s2; the **training curve** alone never settled selection.

Ask while showing the picture

Ask while showing the picture · 4

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the **input**s and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its **evidence**. Then change the supplied condition and compare.

The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

Demonstrate and guide practice

> Demonstrate Training and validation curves, reduce support deliberately and check individual reasoning before discussing answers.

Time or stage	Teacher action
Session 1 start to 7 minutes	Retrieve why training performance alone cannot select for independent performance.
7 to 18 minutes	Identify the two fixed splits and trace checkpoint 1; complete W1.
18 to 32 minutes	Calculate checkpoint 3 by hand and plot all supplied points on one MSE scale.
32 to 45 minutes	Run or trace the evaluation code, then use W2 to practise the exact tie rule.
Session 2 start to 8 minutes	Complete the guided comparison of checkpoints 2 and 4; identify the parameter to restore.
8 to 20 minutes	Use W3 and W5 to examine metric comparability and alternative causes of a widening gap.
20 to 35 minutes	Collect W4 independently with both loss columns and the explicit selection rule.
35 to 45 minutes	Use the exit question and fresh retry; require a distinction between selection and untouched final testing.

Use the worked example in Sections 3 and 6. Collect a **prediction** before revealing its result; ask the learner to point to each intermediate fact.

Provide squared-error columns and labelled axes, allowing calculators. Extension: derive the two quadratic loss expressions and locate their different minima.

Explain why this constructed mismatch makes the validation optimum occur before the **training** optimum.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion practice

Completion task: Observed validation MSE at **checkpoint**s 0 to 4 is [5, 2, 1, 1, 1.2]. Lowest loss wins with earlier exact ties. Which **checkpoint** is selected? What if **training** loss is lowest at **checkpoint** 4?

Reasoning to listen for

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: Select **checkpoint** 2. The tie at 3 does not replace the earlier **checkpoint**. Lower **training** loss at 4 does not change a validation-based rule.

Start by identifying the given **input**s together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood.

For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for **Training** and **validation curve**s. Proposed explanation: “The last **checkpoint** is always best”. Decide whether this explanation is supported.

Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected repair

Expected correction: Choose by the stated validation criterion and restore the saved parameters.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class.

If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Can the original epoch 3 **training** loss 1 justify claiming best generalisation? Point to the relevant step in the picture, then write the changed result and the rule or **evidence** that supports it.

Reasoned teacher answer

No. Original validation loss 2.5 exceeded epoch 2’s2. Freeze the selected **checkpoint** before final evaluation. Changed-case check: Select epoch 3 under the unchanged criterion.

Its measured validation loss is now below epoch 2′s2; the **training curve** alone never settled selection.

Changed-case reasoning: Select epoch 3 under the unchanged criterion. Its measured validation loss is now below epoch 2′s2; the **training curve** alone never settled selection.

Collect each learner′s explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between **input**, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery **evidence**.

TEACHER GUIDE · 4 OF 9

Run the investigation and diagnose misconceptions

> Run the Training and validation curves investigation and use the first unsupported step to choose a teaching response.

The last **checkpoint** is always best: Choose by the stated validation criterion and restore the saved parameters.

A gap proves one specific cause: Check split composition, metrics and evaluation procedures; this demonstration has deliberately different target rules.

Validation is untouched final **evidence**: Once used to choose settings or **checkpoint**s, it is development **evidence**.

Use Section 9 for the **evidence** ledger. Add a boundary or missing-**input** case and record the expected response before checking. More successful repeats of one case do not establish wider coverage.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows	Next teaching action
Missing or misread facts	Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.

What the response shows	Next teaching action
Wrong procedure	Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.
Arithmetic or implementation error	Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.
Correct result without a reason	Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.
An unsupported wider claim	Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal.

Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

Assess and explain the answers

> Use the Training and validation curves questions, teacher keys and criteria after the relevant attempts. Previously discussed cases are practice; protect the separately selected independent task.

Guided and exit questions

Guided: **training** changes by 0.0390625 - 0.625 = -0.5859375; validation changes by 1.7578125 - 0 = 1.7578125. Select **checkpoint** 2 with v = 1.5.

Exit: zero on selected validation examples is limited development **evidence**, and choosing with test results turns that test into development data.

Freeze choices using **training**/validation, then evaluate once on suitable untouched test examples and report the scope.

W1 Recover a plotted point

Workbook question · W1

At v = 1, compute both validation **prediction**s, residuals and MSE on (3, 4.5) and (4, 6).

Teacher reasoning · W1

Teacher explanation: **Prediction**s [3, 4], residuals [-1.5, -2], squares [2.25, 4], MSE 3.125.

W2 Use the declared rule

Workbook question · W2

Observed validation MSE at **checkpoint**s 0 to 4 is [5, 2, 1, 1, 1.2]. Lowest loss wins with earlier exact ties. Which **checkpoint** is selected? What if **training** loss is lowest at **checkpoint** 4?

Teacher reasoning · W2

Teacher explanation: Select **checkpoint** 2. The tie at 3 does not replace the earlier **checkpoint**. Lower **training** loss at 4 does not change a validation-based rule.

W3 Repair incompatible measures

Workbook question · W3

A **training** report shows sum of squared errors 12 over six rows. Validation shows mean squared error 3 over two rows in the same target units. A learner says **training** error is four times larger. Repair the comparison.

Teacher reasoning · W3

Teacher explanation: **Training** MSE is 12 / 6 = 2. Compare 2 with validation MSE 3, not sum 12 with mean 3. The split sizes and examples still limit interpretation.

W4 Evaluate new checkpoints independently

Workbook question · W4

Use h = ReLU(x), y = vh, candidate v values 1, 1.5 and 2. **Training** pairs are (1, 2), (2, 4); validation pairs are (1, 1), (2, 2). Calculate both MSE columns and select by minimum validation MSE.

Explain the disagreement with selection by **training** loss.

Teacher reasoning · W4

Teacher explanation: For v = 1, train MSE 2.5 and validation MSE 0. For v = 1.5, both MSE values are 0.625. For v = 2, train MSE 0 and validation MSE 2.5. Validation chooses v = 1; **training** chooses v = 2.

These constructed splits favour different slopes.

W5 Limit a curve diagnosis

Workbook question · W5

Training loss falls while validation loss rises. Give two checks before declaring model complexity the cause, and explain why repeatedly selecting with validation makes it development **evidence**.

Teacher reasoning · W5

Teacher explanation: Possible checks include comparable loss definitions, unchanged pre**process**ing and evaluation settings, split representativeness, leakage and label quality.

Repeated selection uses validation outcomes to guide choices, so final evaluation needs separate untouched examples.

Independent assessment and fresh retry

Teacher key · Independent assessment and fresh retry

W4 requires all six MSE values and the validation choice v = 1. Fresh retry: candidates v = 0.5, 1, 1.5 and validation pairs (2, 2), (4, 4). MSE values are 2.5, 0 and 2.5, so choose v = 1.

Ask what the result establishes and why it is not final test **evidence** after selection.

Assess independent transfer

Independent question · withhold the key

Selected case: Use h = ReLU(x), y = vh, candidate v values 1, 1.5 and 2. **Training** pairs are (1, 2), (2, 4); validation pairs are (1, 1), (2, 2). Calculate both MSE columns and select by minimum validation MSE.

Explain the disagreement with selection by **training** loss.

Selected case answer

Teacher key · Selected case answer

Teacher explanation: For v = 1, train MSE 2.5 and validation MSE 0. For v = 1.5, both MSE values are 0.625. For v = 2, train MSE 0 and validation MSE 2.5. Validation chooses v = 1; **training** chooses v = 2.

These constructed splits favour different slopes.

Dimension	Evidence required
Explanation	Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.
Trace and result	Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.
Limits	States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Teacher key · Selected case answer

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace.

Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its **evidence** and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case.

Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

Connect the project, support and next lesson

> Connect Training and validation curves to Image-pattern Network Investigation, adapt support and plan a later changed-case check.

Add a labelled **training** and **validation curve**s **evidence** sheet to Image-pattern Network Investigation. Show how you can compute comparable **training** and validation losses at saved **checkpoint**s.

Use the supplied fictional case and keep its **input**s, intermediate steps, calculation or **prediction**, and limitation. Connect this record to last week's record; a matching answer without a trace is insufficient.

Provide squared-error columns and labelled axes, allowing calculators. Extension: derive the two quadratic loss expressions and locate their different minima.

Explain why this constructed mismatch makes the validation optimum occur before the **training** optimum.

Week 16 introduces a weight penalty and a precise early-stopping policy.

Retain the project ledger and assess a changed case after support. Check the relevant prerequisite before carrying this component forward.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-5/16, ai-5/18, ai-5/21. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used.

For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record	Teacher evidence
Learner code and date	
Concept and case used; prior exposure	
Explanation / trace / limits	
Support and first repair	
Changed case and delayed outcome	
Next teaching action	

Use the **evidence** to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For your Image-pattern Network Investigation, save the **input**, procedure, observed result and limitation of this check.

Label this worked example as practice; use a different, previously unreviewed case when checking independent understanding.

Prepare, teach and assess

> Use this preparation summary alongside the detailed Training and validation curves lesson; it is a checklist rather than a replacement for the full sequence.

Teaching target

Teaching target: Compute comparable **training** and validation losses at saved **checkpoint**s

Prepare the labelled worked-case picture, the matching workbook, fictional **input** cards and a place for individual responses. Check a local Python 3 environment before class; have a paper-trace version ready.

Session · Plan · Resources

> **Session:** Session 1 · Understand · 45 min
>
> **Plan:** 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.
>
> **Resources:** Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

> **Session:** Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Plan: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Plan: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

Before class, solve the supported practice: Observed validation MSE at **checkpoint**s 0 to 4 is [5, 2, 1, 1, 1.2]. Lowest loss wins with earlier exact ties. Which **checkpoint** is selected?

What if **training** loss is lowest at **checkpoint** 4?

Supported practice answer

Reasoned practice answer: Teacher explanation: Select **checkpoint** 2. The tie at 3 does not replace the earlier **checkpoint**. Lower **training** loss at 4 does not change a validation-based rule.

Check every learner before discussion: Use the worked case for **Training** and **validation curve**s. Proposed explanation: “The last **checkpoint** is always best”. Decide whether this explanation is supported.

Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Repair the misconception

Misconception repair: Choose by the stated validation criterion and restore the saved parameters.

Support without giving away the answer

Support: read the exact case aloud, enlarge the labelled picture, supply **input** cards and model only the first deciding step. Accept a spoken explanation or drawing; retain the reasoning goal.

Extend the reasoning

Extension: Epoch3 validation loss is instead1.5. Require a **prediction** and a reason before comparing. Expected result: Select epoch 3 under the unchanged criterion.

Reason: Its measured validation loss is now below epoch 2′s2; the **training curve** alone never settled selection.

Protect the independent attempt

Independent assessment: withhold the reserved answer until the learner has attempted the new case. Record support separately from correctness.

Criterion	Not yet	With support	Independent
Explanation	Names an answer without a deciding fact	Uses a hint to link fact and decision	Explains the deciding fact in own words
Trace or test	Cannot connect input and result	Completes steps with prompts	Traces or tests a changed case accurately
Limits and revision	Claims more than evidence supports	Names a limit after a prompt	States a defensible limit and useful next test

Project checkpoint

Project **checkpoint**: Test changed cases. Keep normal, boundary and failure cases; compare expected and observed results.

Use the weekly teacher answer for topic-specific reasoning. A saved progress tick is an activity record; judge mastery from the learner's explanation and **evidence**.

TEACHER GUIDE · 8 OF 9

Use feedback, labs and repair paths

> Use feedback, earlier review and portfolios purposefully. Apply the coding routine only when this lesson has an executable lab.

Use the two formative questions as supported practice, not as independent mastery scores. Discuss the deciding **evidence** rather than accepting a guessed selection.

The feedback comes from the reviewed public worked case. Do not reveal the separately reserved independent teacher answer until the learner has attempted that case.

Ask students to predict before running code. Preserve errors and actual **output**s; collect a changed test and an explanation. The branch-boundary and indexing lessons deliberately include failure cases.

Use the earlier worked-explanation links to address a specific missing building block, then return to the current question. Adapt this suggestion after observing the learner; it is not an automatic diagnosis.

Collect the completed-work portfolio as **evidence**. Record support separately from correctness, and assess explanation, trace/test and limitations. Progress ticks and quiz selections alone do not establish mastery.

TEACHER GUIDE · 9 OF 9

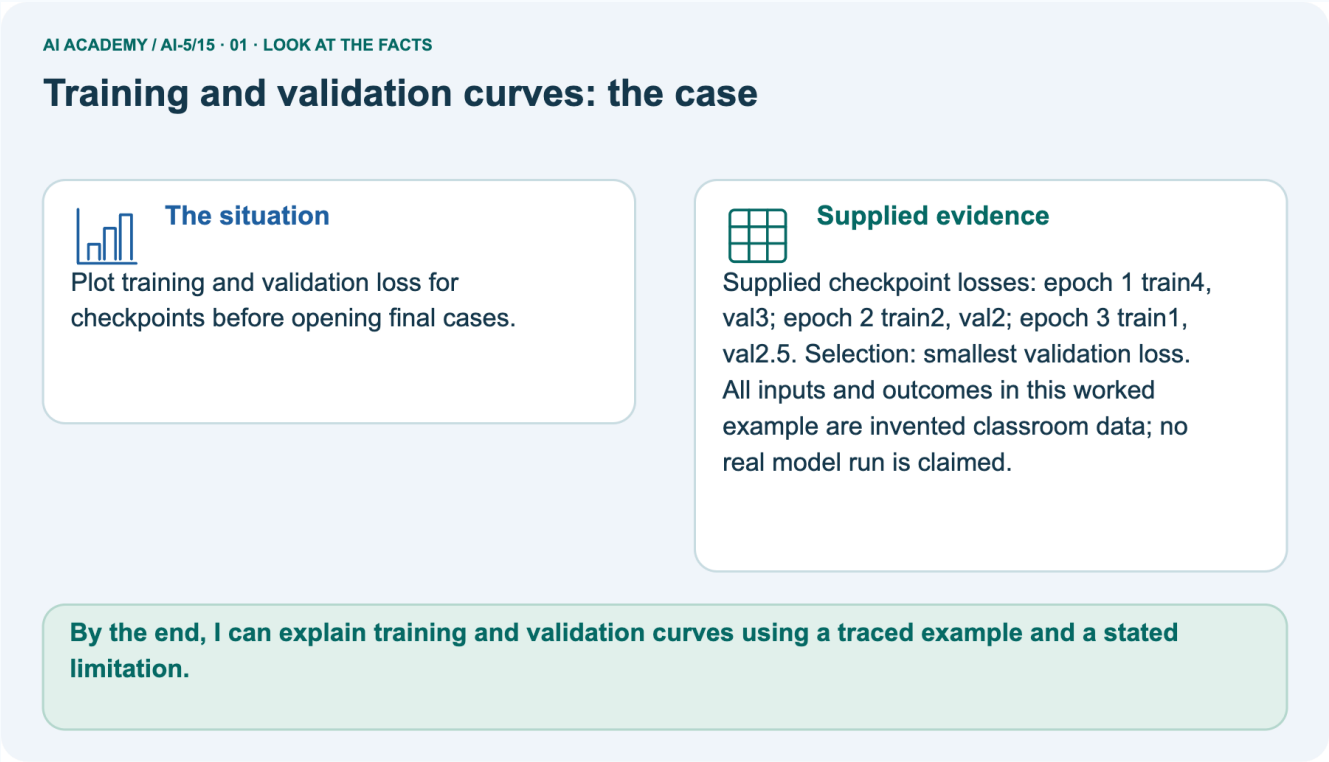
Visual concept journey

> Show one Training and validation curves graphic at a time, request a prediction and discuss

> its trace before the independent assessment.

Use one picture at a time. Hide a worked result before asking for a **prediction**, then reveal it for feedback. These are supported teaching cases; retain the separate independent assessment for a fresh first attempt.

01. Training and validation curves: the case



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Plot **training** and validation loss for **checkpoint**s before opening final cases. Supplied facts: Supplied **checkpoint** losses: epoch 1 train4, val3; epoch 2 train2, val2; epoch 3 train1, val2.5. Selection: smallest validation loss.

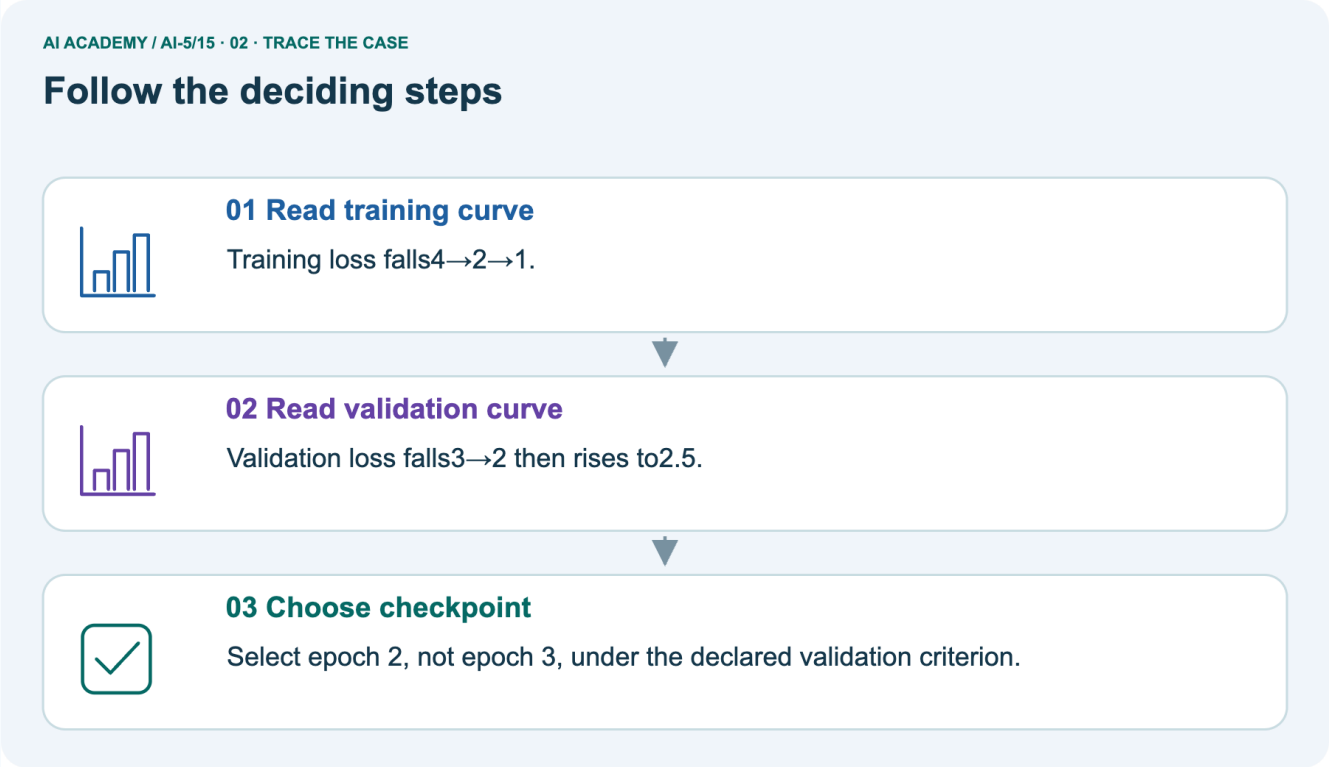
All **input**s and outcomes in this worked example are invented classroom data; no real model run is claimed.

> Point to the given fact that matters most. Explain why it matters.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Point to the given fact that matters most. Explain why it matters. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

02. Follow the deciding steps



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Read **training curve**: **Training** loss falls4→2→1. → Read **validation curve**: Validation loss falls3→2 then rises to2.5. → Choose **checkpoint**: Select epoch 2, not epoch 3, under the declared validation criterion.

Point to each numbered stage and explain which recorded **input** it uses.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Point to each numbered stage and explain which recorded **input** it uses. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

03. Checkpoint losses



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Checkpoint losses. epoch 1: **training** = 4, validation = 3. epoch 2: **training** = 2, validation = 2. epoch 3: **training** = 1, validation = 2.5.

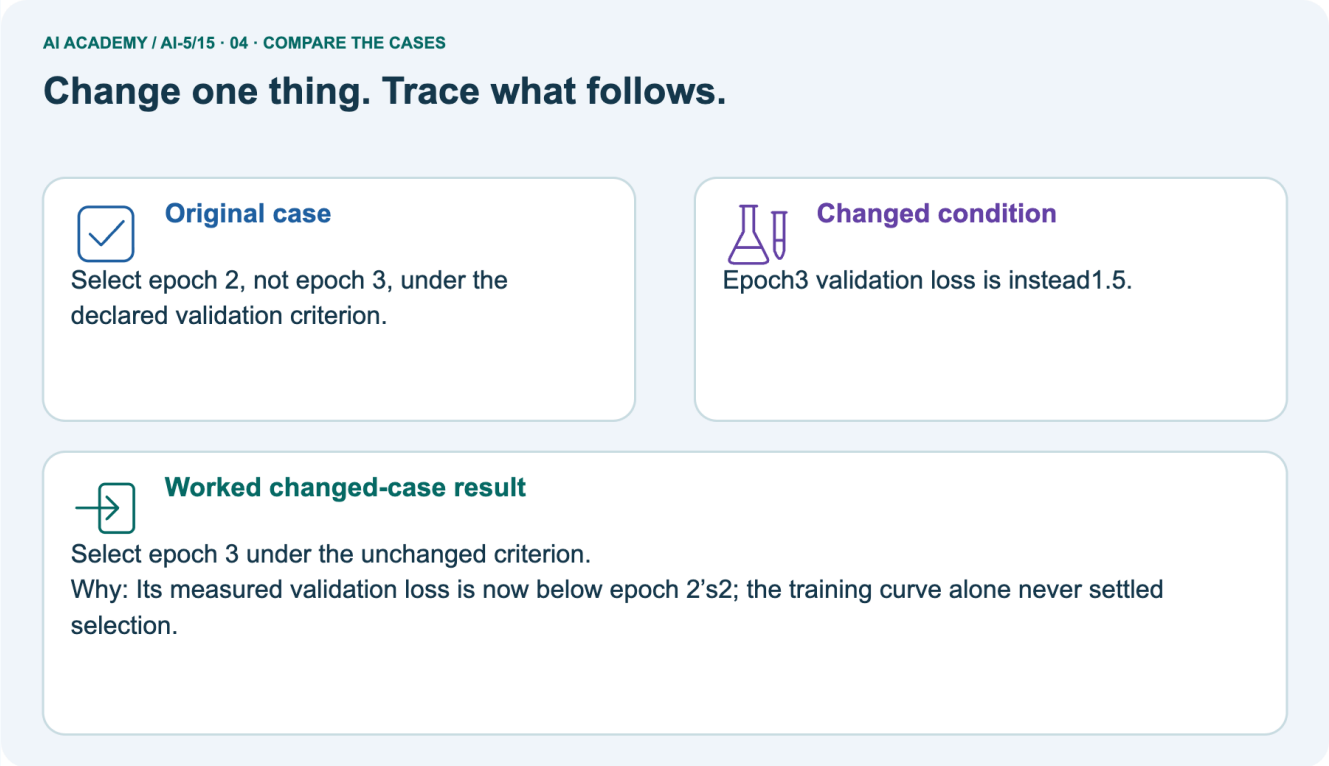
Read the labels and values. Explain the relationship the model shows.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Read the labels and values. Explain the relationship the model shows. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Check row/column meanings, units and denominators before discussing a difference. Supplied toy values are not real class or model results.

04. Change one thing. Trace what follows.



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Original case: Select epoch 2, not epoch 3, under the declared validation criterion. Changed condition: Epoch3 validation loss is instead1.5. Expected result: Select epoch 3 under the unchanged criterion.

Reason: Its measured validation loss is now below epoch 2′s2; the **training curve** alone never settled selection.

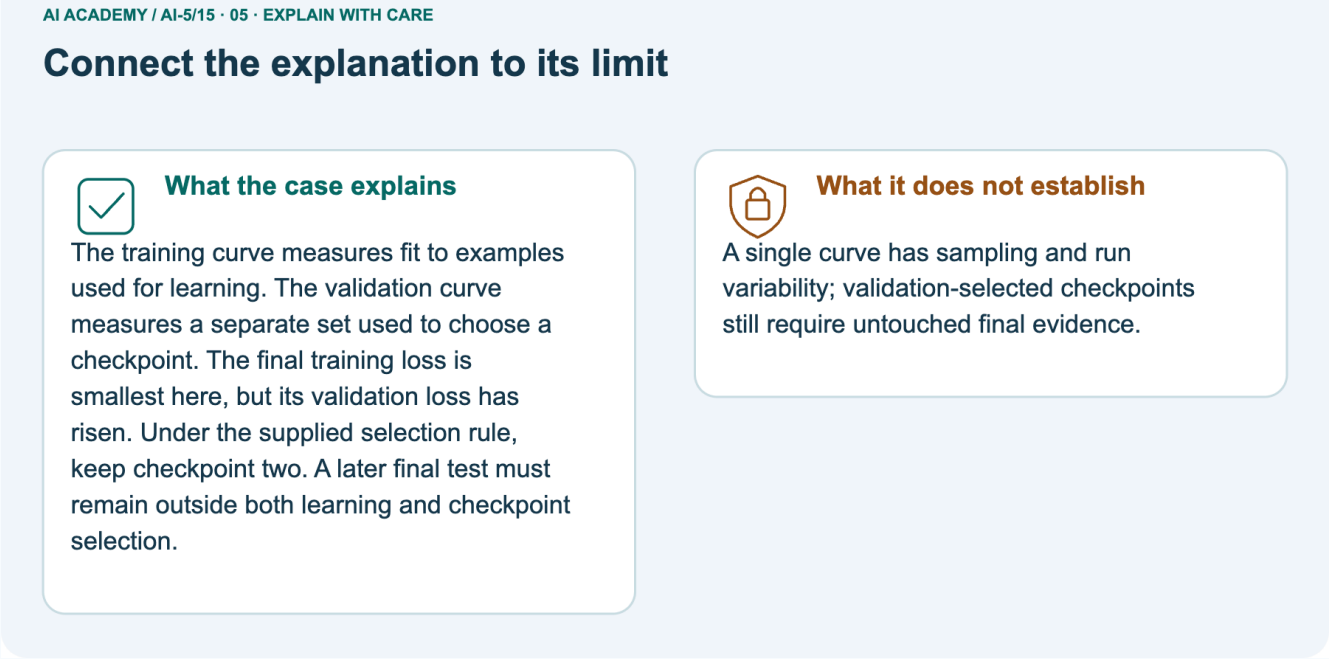
Predict before checking the worked changed-case result. Name what changed and what the supplied facts allow you to conclude.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Predict before checking the worked changed-case result. Name what changed and what the supplied facts allow you to conclude. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words.

Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see. Changed-case reasoning: Its measured validation loss is now below epoch 2′s2; the **training curve** alone never settled selection.

05. Connect the explanation to its limit



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

The **training curve** measures fit to examples used for learning. The **validation curve** measures a separate set used to choose a **checkpoint**. The final **training** loss is smallest here, but its validation loss has risen.

Under the supplied **selection rule**, keep **checkpoint** two. A later final test must remain outside both learning and **checkpoint** selection.

Limit: A single curve has sampling and run variability; validation-selected **checkpoint**s still require untouched final **evidence**.

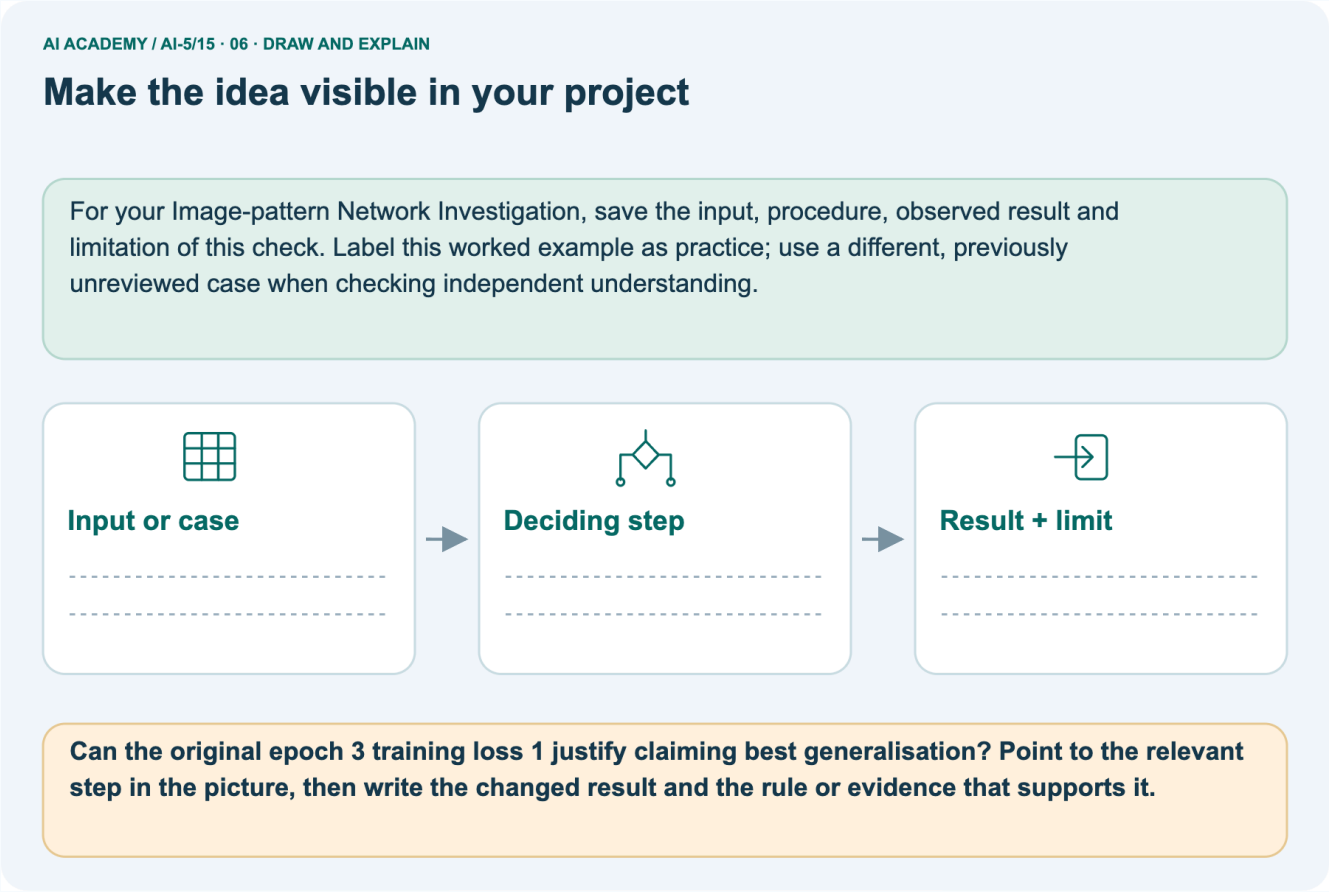
Explain the case, then point to a limit on the claim.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Explain the case, then point to a limit on the claim. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Keep the stated scope: A single curve has sampling and run variability; validation-selected **checkpoint**s still require untouched final **evidence**.

06. Make the idea visible in your project



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

For your Image-pattern Network Investigation, save the **input**, procedure, observed result and limitation of this check.

Label this worked example as practice; use a different, previously unreviewed case when checking independent understanding. Draw your **input**, deciding step, result and limit.

Supported question: Can the original epoch 3 **training** loss 1 justify claiming best generalisation? Point to the relevant step in the picture, then write the changed result and the rule or **evidence** that supports it.

> Draw your project trace and justify the deciding step using **evidence**.

Discuss while showing the picture

Teacher prompt: Draw your project trace and justify the deciding step using **evidence**. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Supported practice key: No. Original validation loss 2.5 exceeded epoch 2′s2. Freeze the selected **checkpoint** before final evaluation. Changed-case check: Select epoch 3 under the unchanged criterion.

Its measured validation loss is now below epoch 2′s2; the **training curve** alone never settled selection.

Save or print your responses for your portfolio. Progress and drafts on the hosted website stay in the current browser. Use only fictional or teacher-approved data.